

STORY FORMAT BIBLE: THE REAL-WORLD STORY

STATUS:  LOCKED (format).  THE REAL-WORLD STORY HAS STARTED with Chapter One, "The Brainiac Kid" (April 28 – September 29, 2006).

This document covers **our story about the people making the MCU**: the actors, the families, the executives and the fans. That's separate from the MCU films themselves, which follow the Franchise Bible.

1. FORMAT: ENSEMBLE MOCKUMENTARY

Structure: an **ensemble story** with **Marc-Anthony Bullock as the primary protagonist**. His journey is the spine and every chapter touches it. Around him the POV rotates among the ensemble: Amond, Tayia, Esther, Tyrese, Harmony, Tyler, Elxa, Grace, Arianna, the Donohue-Bullock family, Kevin Feige and the executives, and the fans.

The mockumentary conceit: a documentary crew is embedded with the ensemble. **Origin (canon, Chapter One):** the independent crew started following Marc-Anthony in **April 2006** for a film about child stars growing up. Marvel discovered them at his screen test and **sealed the footage by agreement on Friday, August 18, 2006**. Earlier Marvel scenes come from **Kevin Feige's personal Handycam** ("the Feige Tapes"), donated to the documentary. **The footage is sealed** under Marvel NDAs as a time capsule of the secret, to be released only after the Infinity Saga ends. That's why people are candid on camera about a secret the public doesn't know yet.

The toolkit

Device	How we use it
Talking heads	Confessional interviews, always with a lower-third : MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK – Actor, "Tony Stark" – Age 25
Fly-on-the-wall scenes	Screenplay format: sets, offices, homes, cars, premieres
The look	A character glances at the camera after something absurd or heartbreaking
Camera catches it	Things people didn't know were being filmed: whispered phone calls, hot mics, reactions through a doorway
Archival footage	Clips from <i>SPLAT!</i> , <i>Brainiac</i> , <i>Sunny</i> , Tyrese's music videos, <i>Crime Lab: Baltimore</i> , old Donohue home movies
Media inserts	Variety, THR, Deadline, <i>Entertainment Tonight</i> , <i>Access Hollywood</i> , talk shows, box office charts
The internet	Forums (SuperHeroHype, AICN, CBR), MySpace, Twitter, YouTube, and later Facebook, Tumblr, Instagram and Reddit as each becomes big in the real world
Title cards	Date, time, location, and a countdown when it matters
Bleeps	Used as a comedy device. Marc-Anthony's unfiltered mouth runs the censor ragged, and sometimes we just let it play.

Running gags (locked)

Gag	Where it lives
Marc's ad-libs	Every set. The script says one thing and Marc says another. Directors learn to shoot " one for Marc. " The ad-lib log grows chapter by chapter, and the best lines end up quoted on T-shirts.
Marc's hidden snacks	Every set. Stashes behind flats, in props, and later inside his suits. Crew "snack hunts." Started at the <i>Iron Man</i> screen test (Chapter One: peanut butter crackers behind the scrap pile).
"Marc IS Tony"	The press, the fans and the culture slowly stop telling them apart. It's his crown and his cage.

2. SERIALIZED vs. STANDALONE

The target: 80% SERIALIZED / 20% STANDALONE

Why 80%: real life doesn't reset between episodes. This is a **twelve-year chronicle (2007–2019)**, and everything that matters builds over time:

- careers and comebacks
- the MCU secret slowly getting out
- the slow-burn romances (Marc & Esther in 2011, Amond & Harmony in 2013)
- the families, and later the kids
- rivalries, box office pressure, and the arrival of social media

Why 20% standalone: every chapter still needs its own **self-contained A-story** with a beginning, middle and end:

- a premiere night
- a Comic-Con panel
- an awards show
- a disastrous talk-show appearance
- one 18-hour shoot day
- a Thanksgiving at the Donohue estate

Every tenth chapter or so is a **true standalone "special episode"** that works even if you've never read anything else, like a *Behind the Music*-style retrospective or a fan-convention day told entirely from the fans' side.

THE CONTINUITY LAWS (real-world story)

1. **The Ledger.** Every chapter opens with date, time and location, and every age is calculated from birthdays. Nobody ages at the wrong time.
2. **Nothing is forgotten.** Jokes, grudges, injuries, promises, and one-off mentions like "Somebody's getting named Brenda" all come back.
3. **Real history is fixed.** Real-world events (the 2007–08 writers' strike, the 2008 financial crash, the 2009 Disney deal, the rise of Twitter and Instagram) happen when they really happened, and the story reacts to them.
4. **The MCU calendar matches the Franchise Bible.** Filming dates, release dates and box office numbers stay consistent across both documents.
5. **Sealed canon stays sealed** until its date arrives: the relationships, the twins, Lyric, the net worth.
6. **Characters grow, they never reset.** What happened in Chapter One is still true in Chapter One Hundred.

3. GENRE, SUBGENRES & RATING

Primary genre: Ensemble Comedy-Drama (Mockumentary)

It should make you laugh out loud and then hit you in the chest two pages later.

Subgenres

Subgenre	What it brings	Tonal touchstones
Hollywood satire	Agents, studio politics, trade-paper headlines, box office panic	<i>The Larry Sanders Show, Entourage, The Comeback</i>
Workplace mockumentary	The documentary crew, talking heads, the looks to camera	<i>The Office, Parks and Recreation, Abbott Elementary</i>
Family saga	Three generations of the Donohue–Bullock dynasty, legacy and generational wealth	<i>This Is Us, Soul Food</i>
Underdog sports-movie arc	A studio that's never made a movie and a cast of typecast actors take on Hollywood	<i>Moneyball, Remember the Titans</i>
Slow-burn romance	Friends-to-lovers, years in the making	<i>Love & Basketball, The Best Man</i>
Comeback / second-act drama	Child stars trying to grow up on screen	<i>The Wrestler, Birdman</i>
Media thriller (light)	Leaks, set photos, spoilers, the fight to keep the secret	<i>Spotlight, The Newsroom</i>

Tone in one line: *The Office* meets *Entourage* meets *This Is Us*, with Marc-Anthony at the center.

Rating: TV-MA (L)

- **Language: uncensored.** Marc-Anthony's comedy is unhinged, unfiltered and offensive by design, and it doesn't work watered down. The bleep is a comedy device, not a rule.
 - **Adult themes:** industry racism, typecasting, money, pressure, grief and fame, handled honestly.
 - **Sexual content: kept off the page.** The romances are about the relationships, not the bedroom.
 - **Heart: 100%.** Once the kids arrive, the story gets warmer without getting softer.
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4. PROTAGONIST & ENSEMBLE MAP

Tier	Characters
Primary protagonist	Marc-Anthony Bullock
Core ensemble	Amond Baker · Esther Smalley · Tayia Boyd · Grace Bullock · Elxa Bullock · Tyrese Avery · Harmony Divine · Tyler Chapman · Arianna Cummings
The dynasty	Victor & Joan Donohue · Natasha & Robert Bullock
The studio	Kevin Feige · David Maisel · Marvel and Disney executives · directors
Real-life cast	Samuel L. Jackson, Don Cheadle, Jeff Bridges, Jon Favreau, Stan Lee, and every other real actor per the Casting Rules
The chorus	The press and the fans. XxWolverineXx has been locked in as a recurring skeptic since Chapter One.

✓ STARTED. [Chapter One: "The Brainiac Kid"](#)